



Diversity in psychology means that people are different in many ways, like their culture, gender, age, or beliefs. Psychologists study these differences to understand how they affect our thoughts, feelings, and behaviors.

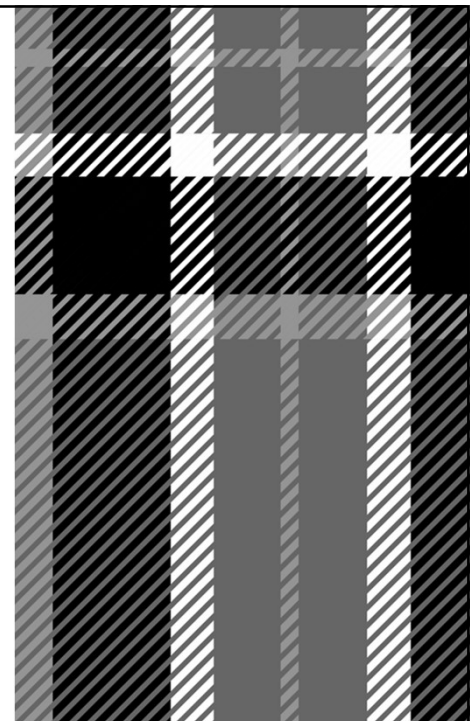
Why the study of diversity and culture is important?

Broadened Perspectives: Exposure to diverse cultures fosters open-mindedness and a broader worldview, helping students understand and appreciate different perspectives.

Critical Thinking: Engaging with various cultural contexts encourages critical thinking about social issues, power dynamics, and the impact of cultural norms on behavior.

Improved Communication: Understanding cultural differences enhances communication skills, which are essential in both personal and professional contexts, especially in a globalized world.

Social Responsibility: Awareness of diversity promotes social responsibility and empathy, preparing students to engage thoughtfully with diverse communities and advocate for social justice.



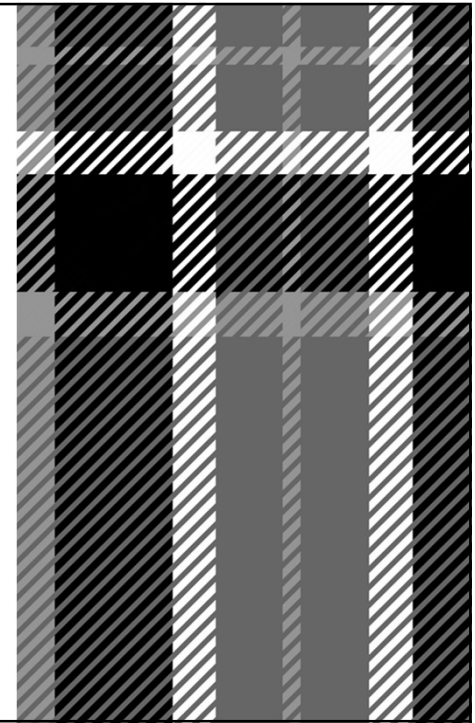
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Workplace Preparedness: Many careers require collaboration with people from different backgrounds. Familiarity with cultural diversity equips students to work effectively in diverse teams.

Innovation and Creativity: Exposure to varied cultural ideas can inspire creativity and innovation, as diverse viewpoints often lead to new solutions and approaches.

Personal Growth: Engaging with different cultures fosters personal development, self-awareness, and a deeper understanding of one's own cultural identity.

Overall, the study of culture and diversity enriches the educational experience and prepares students to navigate an increasingly interconnected world.



Diversity

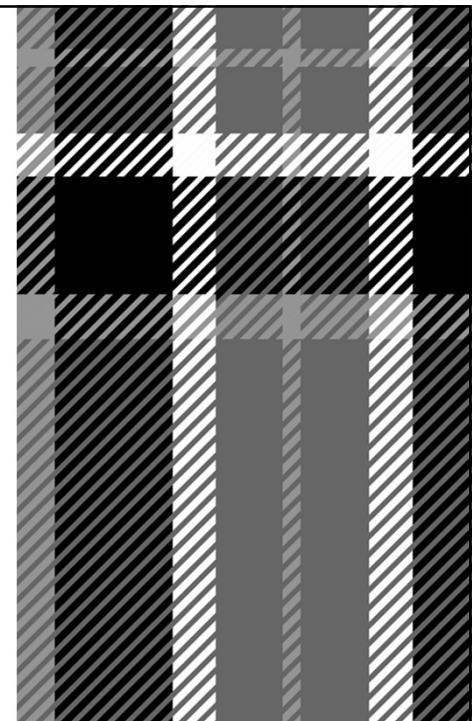
- Diversity refers to the ways in which people are **similar or different from each other**. It may be defined by any characteristic that varies within a particular work unit such as gender, race, age, education, tenure, or functional background.
- What are the **benefits and challenges** of diversity in the organizations?

Benefits of Diversity

More Creativity ,Better Performance ,Wider Customer Reach ,Higher Employee Satisfaction,Improved Decision Making, Good Reputation , Better Adaptability

Challenges of Diversity

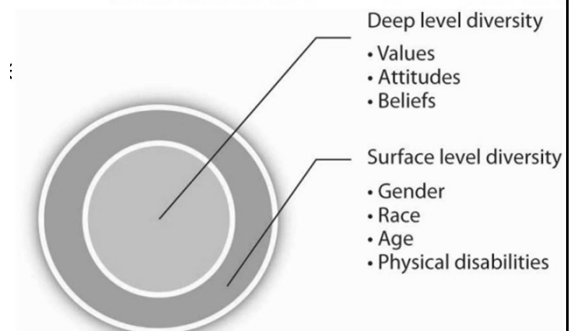
Unconscious Bias ,Communication Issues ,Resistance to Change, Tokenism ,Team Conflicts, Resource Needs, Legal Compliance



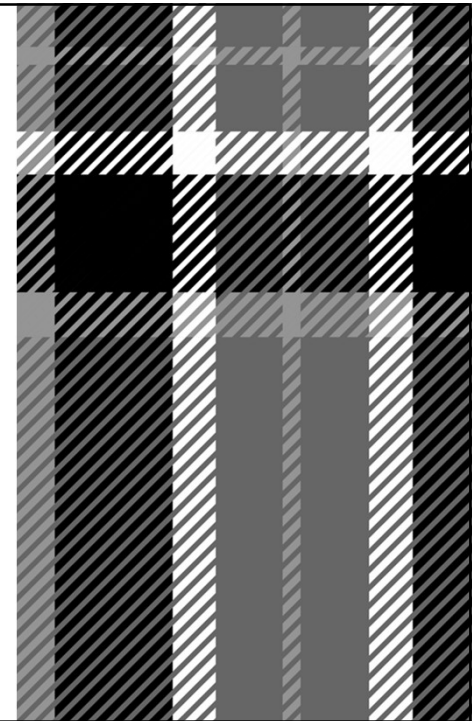
Levels of Diversity

Surface-level diversity: This refers to differences that are easy to see, like gender, race, ethnicity, or age. These traits don't show how people think or feel, but they can lead to assumptions or stereotypes about individuals.

Deep-level diversity: This involves differences that are less visible, such as people's values, personalities, and work styles. As people get to know each other better, these deeper qualities become more important in understanding how similar or different they are.



Biographical characteristics: Personal characteristics—such as age, gender, race, and ethnicity—that are objective and easily obtained from personnel records. These characteristics are representative of **surface-level diversity**.



RACE VS. ETHNICITY

What's the Difference?

Race	Ethnicity
Refers to a person's physical characteristics such as skin color, hair texture, and facial features.	Refers to a person's cultural background, including language, religion, customs, and traditions.
Often used to categorize people based on physical appearance.	Often used to describe a person's cultural identity.
Can be a socially constructed concept with no biological basis.	Can be a complex and multifaceted identity that includes many different cultural factors.
Examples: Black, White, Asian, Native American.	Examples: Hispanic, African, Jewish, Irish.

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Age in the workplace

Age will become more important in workplaces over the next ten years for several reasons.

More Older Workers: In many countries, there are more older people working because they are living longer and staying in jobs longer.

Changing Views: People used to think older workers were out of touch or not flexible, but that's changing.

Good Qualities: Managers see that older workers bring many benefits, like:

Experience: They know a lot from their years at work.

Smart Decisions: They often make good choices based on their knowledge.

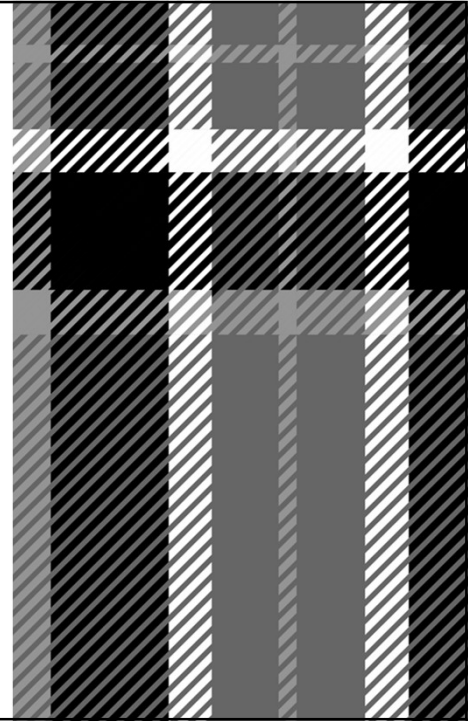
Hard Work: They usually work very hard.

Quality Focus: They care about doing their jobs well.

Generational Differences

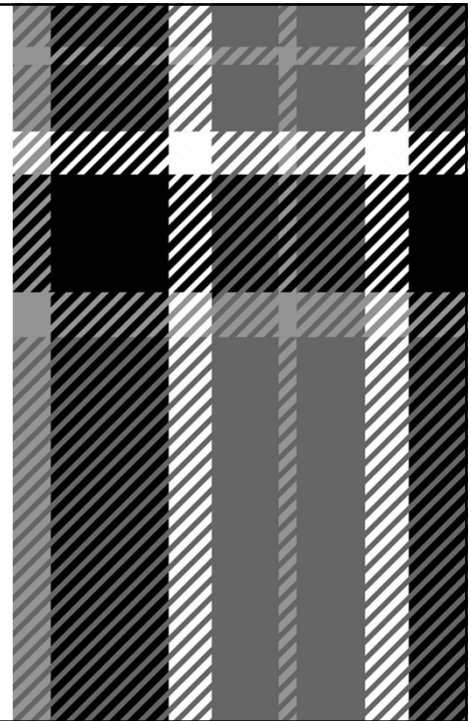
Baby Boomers

Baby Boomers are roughly between the ages of **55 and 75**. This group often looks for ways to move up in their jobs and set clear goals for their careers. They usually prefer face-to-face communication and like having some rules and structure in the workplace.



Generation X

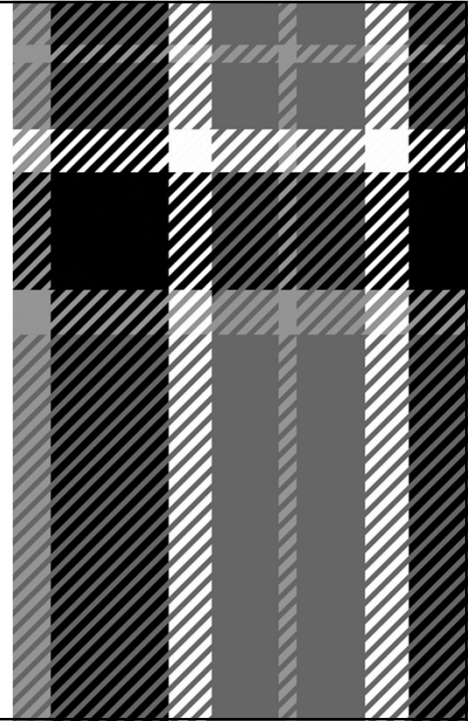
Generation X includes people who are about 40 to 60 years old. They are at a key point in their careers and are often reaching their highest earning potential. Growing up with both parents working, they are usually very hardworking, flexible, and comfortable with technology.



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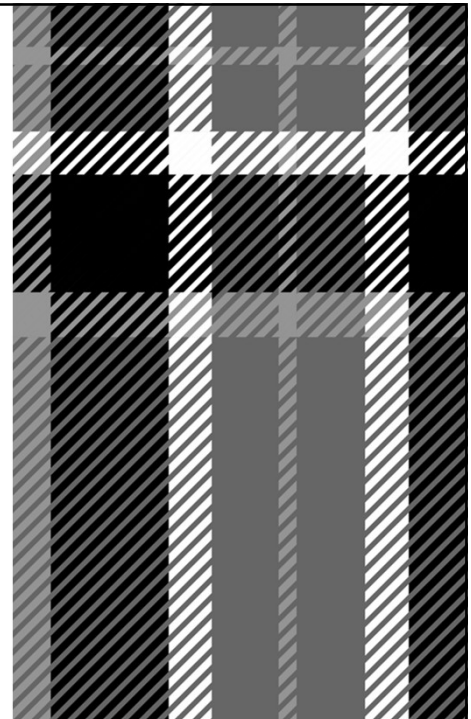
Generation Y (Millennials)

Millennials are people who are currently about 20 to 40 years old. They are known for being good with technology and focused on achieving their goals. Many want their jobs to have a positive impact on the world and seek meaning beyond just earning money.



Generation Z

Generation Z, born between 1997 and 2012, is the youngest group in the workforce today, with most between 18 and 25 years old. They grew up with the internet, making them very comfortable with technology and quick to learn new tools. Money is a big motivator for them, as many are focused on financial security. This generation is also the most diverse in history, valuing inclusion and fairness at work. They look for jobs that offer good pay, flexible schedules, and opportunities to grow while aligning with their personal values. Gen Z is set to bring fresh ideas and energy to the workplace.



5 benefits of age diversity in the workplace

1. Increased productivity
2. Improve skill diversity
3. Build an inclusive business
4. Create mentorship opportunities
5. Improve employee retention

Source: <https://vervoe.com/age-diversity/>

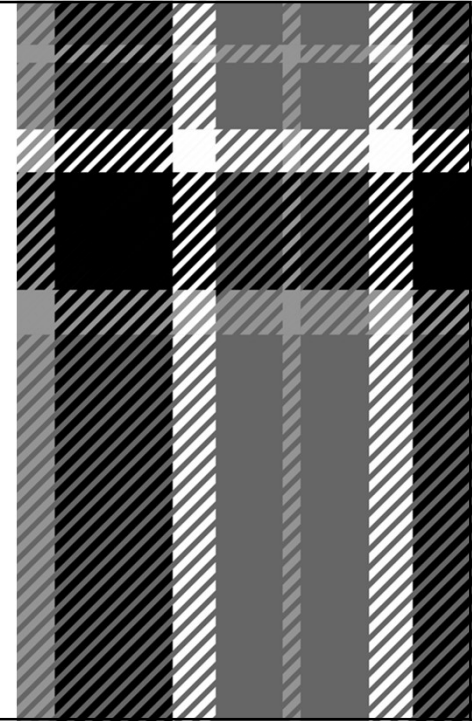
Prejudice and stereotypes

Prejudice means judging someone unfairly without knowing them, often based on things like their race, gender, or age.

Stereotypes are ideas that society automatically connects to certain groups of people, based on things like age, weight, job, skin color, or gender. These ideas may not always be true and can lead to unfair assumptions about individuals.

Discrimination

Discrimination: Treating people unfairly or differently because they belong to a certain group, giving some groups more advantages while holding others back.



Discrimination happens when people are treated unfairly because of who they are. Here are some common forms:

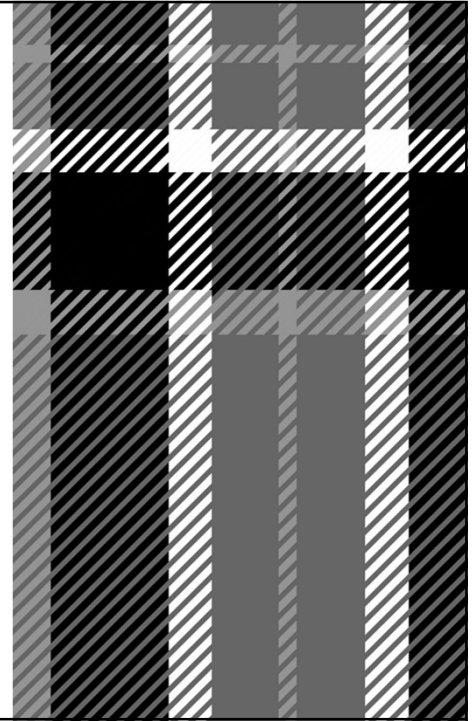
1. **Racial Discrimination** – Treating someone unfairly because of their race or skin color.
2. **Gender Discrimination** – Unequal treatment based on gender, like paying women less than men for the same job.
3. **Age Discrimination** – Treating people unfairly because they are too young or too old.
4. **Disability Discrimination** – Not giving equal opportunities to people with disabilities.
5. **Religious Discrimination** – Mistreating someone because of their religion or beliefs.
6. **Sexual Orientation Discrimination** – Treating people unfairly because of who they love or their sexual identity.
7. **Economic Discrimination** – Judging or mistreating people based on their financial status.
8. **Caste Discrimination** – Unequal treatment based on social class or caste in some cultures.

Discrimination can happen anywhere—at work, school, or in daily life—and it's important to work towards fairness and equality for everyone.

Culture

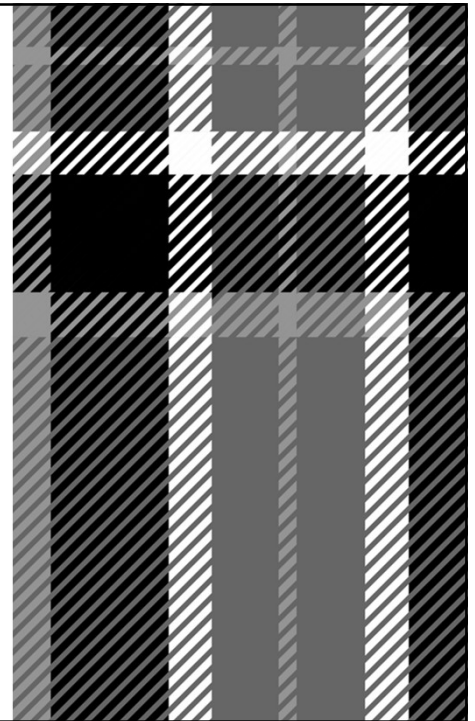
The word "culture" derives from a French term, which in turn derives from the Latin "colere," which means to tend to the earth and grow, or cultivation and nurture" (Cristina De Rossi)

Culture is the way of life for a group of people. It includes things like their language, food, music, traditions, and beliefs. Culture helps shape how people think and act, and it can change over time based on different influences like history and new ideas



Defining Culture

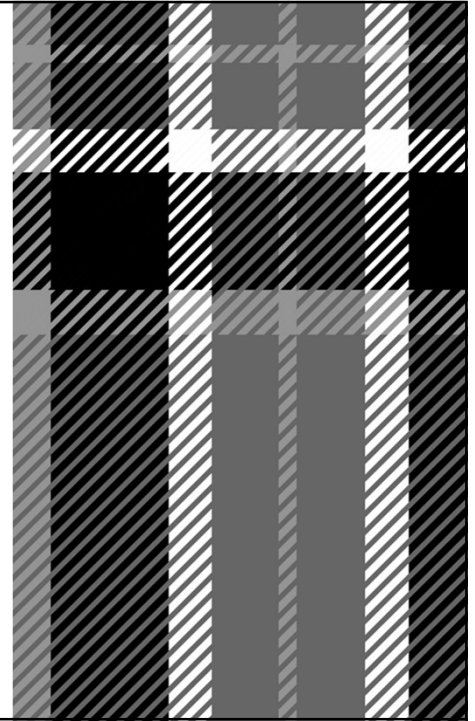
Culture is the shared way of life of a group of people, encompassing their knowledge, beliefs, arts, morals, laws, customs, and habits. It shapes how individuals think and act, influencing their values and social interactions. Culture includes both ideas, such as what is considered right or important, and tangible elements, like tools and artistic expressions, that together create a unique identity for a community. Essentially, culture is the collective experience that defines how people live and relate to one another.



Characteristics of Culture

Culture is learnt: Culture is acquired through social interactions, not inherited biologically. People learn behaviors, customs, and values from those around them.

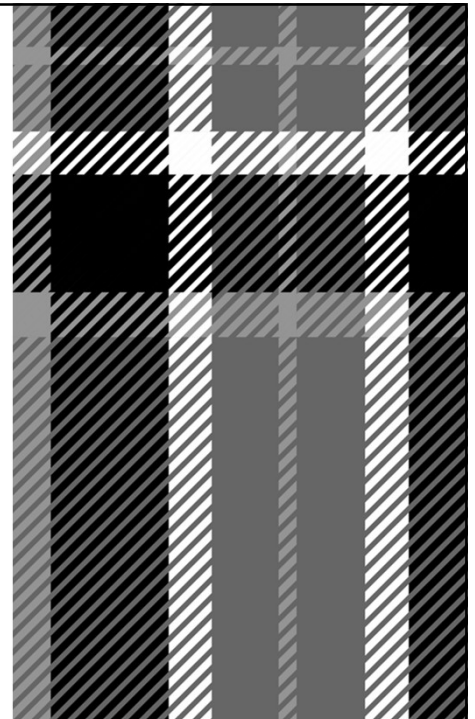
Culture is Social : Culture exists within society and develops through interactions among individuals. It's a shared experience, meaning everyone in a community participates in and contributes to it.



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Culture is Shared: Culture is a collective experience; it cannot be possessed by an individual alone. Customs, traditions, beliefs, values, and morals are all shared among members of a group or society.

Culture is Transmissive: Culture is passed down from one generation to the next. Parents teach their children cultural traits, who then pass these on to their own children. This transmission happens through language, which is the primary way culture is communicated.



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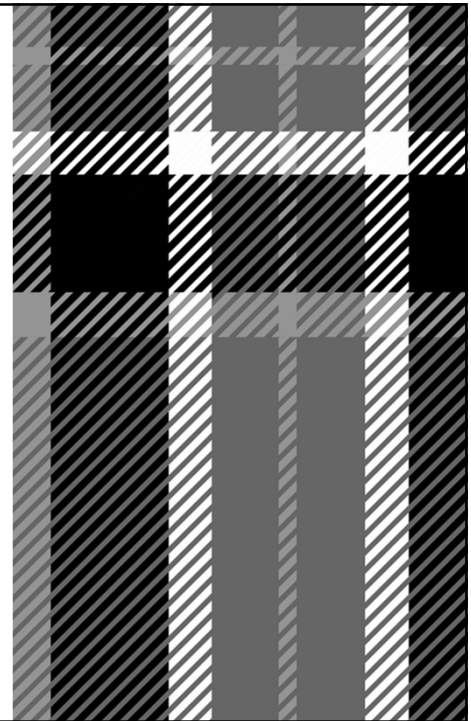
Culture is Dynamic and Adaptive: Culture adapts to new conditions in the physical world , helping people survive and thrive in different environments.

Symbolic: Culture relies on symbols, such as language, rituals, and art, to convey meanings and communicate ideas.

Culture Varies: Each society has its own unique culture, which differs from others. Cultures are not uniform; they reflect the distinct experiences, practices, and values of each community.

Components of Culture

- Values
- Norms
- Symbols
- Language

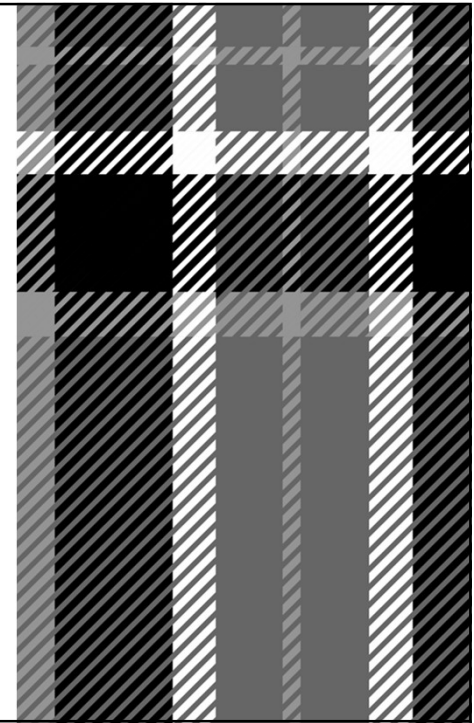


Values and beliefs

Values – Values are shared ideas about what is good, bad, desirable, or proper in a society. They guide how people should live and what they find important or morally right or wrong. Examples of values include:

- Respect for parents and elders
- Cleanliness
- Generosity

Values are broad principles that support our specific beliefs, which are the individual thoughts or ideas we hold to be true.



Norms

Norms: Norms are rules made by a group that tell people how to behave. They explain what you must do, should do, may do, should not do, and must not do. These rules help everyone know what's acceptable, making it easier to get along in a community.

NORMS VERSUS VALUES

NORMS	VALUES
Norms are accepted standards of behaviour	Values are principles that help you to decide what is right and wrong
Specific guidelines	General guidelines
Behaviours that are accepted by the society	Principals believed by an individual
May vary from society to society	May vary from individual to individual
Ex: covering your mouth when coughing, shaking hands when you meet someone, saying sorry when you bump into someone, etc.	Ex: honesty, integrity, courage, kindness, fairness, and generosity

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Folkways

Folkways are the everyday customs and behaviors that people follow in a culture. They're like unwritten rules that everyone knows. For example, when you shake hands when you meet someone or say "excuse me" when you bump into someone. If you break these rules, people might think it's odd, but you won't face serious consequences.

Mores

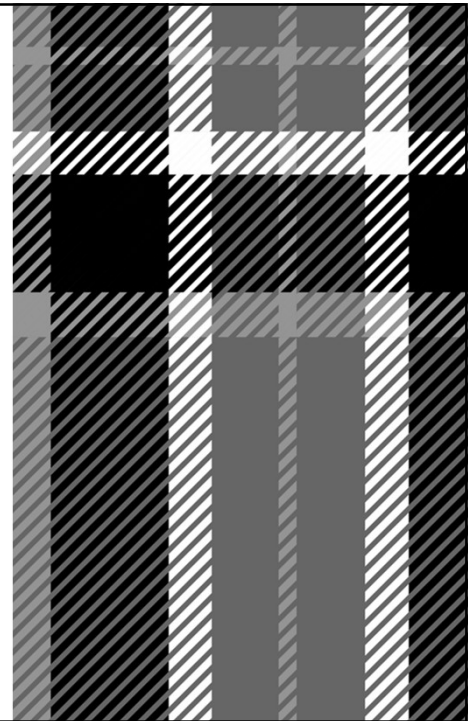
Mores (pronounced "mor-ays") are more serious than folkways. These are norms that are very important to a culture and are linked to morals. Breaking these rules can lead to severe consequences, like being shunned by society or even going to jail. Examples include serious crimes like murder or incest, which are seen as very wrong.

Laws

Laws are the official rules created by governments. They are formal norms that everyone is expected to follow. If you break a law, there are legal consequences, like fines or imprisonment. Laws are enforced by police and other authorities.

Taboos

Taboos are strict cultural rules against certain behaviors, like incest or cannibalism. Breaking them can cause disgust and lead to rejection or punishment. They help maintain social order by shaping acceptable behavior.



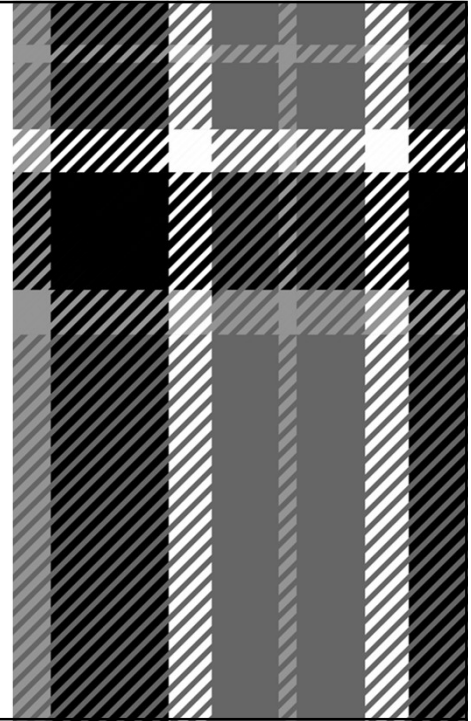
Symbols

Symbols: A symbol is an object, word, or action that stands for something else.

Symbol is anything that carries a particular meaning recognized by people who share a culture (a flag, a word, a flashing red light, a raised fist, an animal etc).

Symbols help us communicate ideas. A siren is a symbol that denotes an emergency situation and sends the message to clear the way immediately

Non-verbal gestures can be very "symbolic" and diverse.



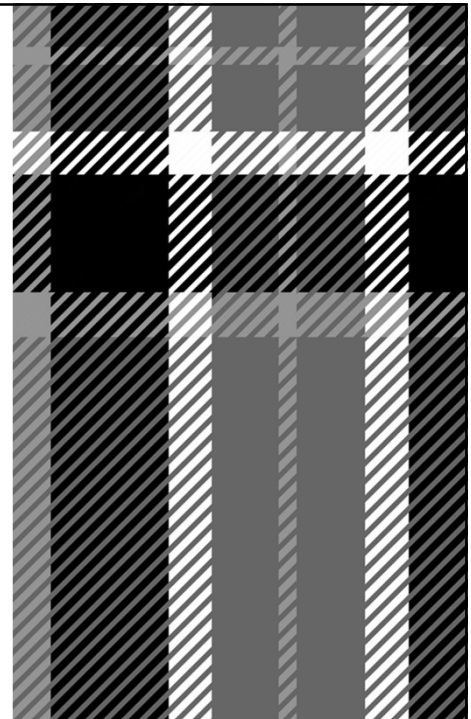
Language

Language: Culture is the social heritage of the humans that is transmitted to the future generation mainly through language.

Language is a system of words and symbols used to communicate with other people.

Language is a set of symbols that expresses ideas and enables people to think and communicate with one another.

Verbal (spoken) language and nonverbal (written or gestured) language help us describe reality.

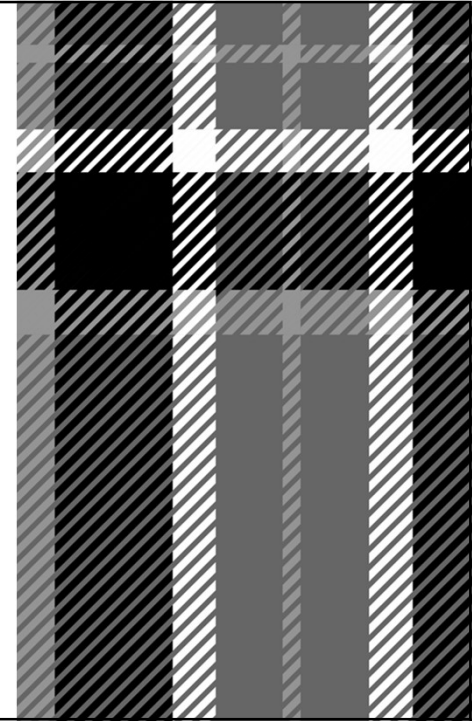


Ethnocentrism & Cultural Shock

Ethnocentrism: the tendency to judge other cultures according to the norms and values of our own culture. Ethnocentrism is based on the assumption that one's own way of life is **superior** to all others.

Culture shock is the term we use to describe the feelings of confusion and uncertainty that are experienced when you come into contact with a culture that is vastly different from your own.

Culture shock can be commonly seen in foreign students, immigrants and refugees. Suddenly, you find yourself unable to understand.



Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions is a theory that explains how cultures differ in their values and behaviors. It was created by Geert Hofstede, a Dutch psychologist, to help understand how people from different countries think and act. The theory includes **six dimensions**:

Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions explain how cultures differ in six ways:

1. **Power Distance** – How much inequality people accept (high = strict hierarchy, low = equality).
2. **Individualism vs. Collectivism** – Focus on personal goals (individual) or group harmony (collective).
3. **Masculinity vs. Femininity** – Competitive and success-driven (masculine) vs. caring and cooperative (feminine).
4. **Uncertainty Avoidance** – Preference for rules and stability (high) vs. comfort with risk and change (low).
5. **Long-Term vs. Short-Term Orientation** – Future planning and patience (long-term) vs. quick results and traditions (short-term).
6. **Indulgence vs. Restraint** – Enjoying life and freedom (indulgence) vs. self-discipline and strict norms (restraint).

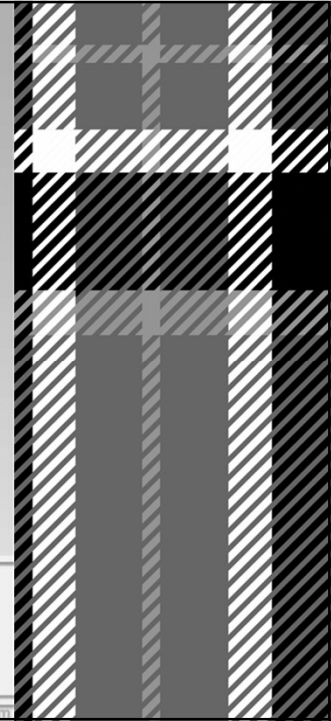


Individualist Cultures	Collectivist Cultures
- The individual is the most important - Focus on individual goals and achievement - Promotes <u>self expression</u>, <u>individual thinking</u>, <u>personal choice</u> - Personal privacy and space are important - Business is competitive (focus on leadership)	- The group is most important - Focus on well-being and goals of the group - Promotes <u>respect for others</u> and <u>teamwork</u> - Relationship, collaboration, and sharing are important - Business is collaborative (focus on membership)

Source: Hannah Bierbaum

High vs. Low power distance

Features of high power distance cultures	Features of low power distance cultures
Members accept power distance as part of social order, it determines what is right and wrong.	Power is exerted only where it is necessary.
More powerful members of society perceive their subordinates as unequal.	People are equal, they consider social inequalities obsolete.
Subordinates fear the more powerful members.	Cooperation should be based on the principle of solidarity.
There is not much trust among co-workers	Subordinates are considered as older, more experienced colleagues.
Majority of people are dependent on others.	Co-workers are prone to trust one another.
Subordinates are blamed for mistakes.	The system is blamed for mistakes.
There is a strong conflict between the strong and the weak members	Everyone should have equal rights
Social inequalities are accepted; every person has a high or low place in the social order and is protected by law	Strong and weak members coexist in harmony



Uncertainty Avoiding societies

- The uncertainty inherent in life is a threat that must be fought
- High stress and anxiety
- Aggression and emotions may sometimes be vented
- What is different, is dangerous
- Need for rules, even if not practical and/or not practised
- Formalization
- Adoption of innovations slow
- Staying in the same job
- Xenophobia

Uncertainty Accepting societies

- Uncertainty is normal, life is accepted as it comes
- Low stress and anxiety
- Aggression and emotions should be controlled
- What is different, is curious
- Fewer rules, which may be broken if necessary
- Deregulation
- Adoption of innovations fast
- Changing jobs easily
- Tolerance

D.4 Masculinity versus Femininity

Masculinity	Femininity
Dominant values in society are material success and progress	Dominant values in society are caring for others and preservation
Money and things are important	People and warm relationships are important
Men are supposed to be assertive, ambitious, and tough	Everybody is supposed to be modest
Women are supposed to be tender and to take care of relationships	Both men and women are allowed to be tender and to be concerned with relationships
Sympathy for the strong	Sympathy for the weak

Traits

Short-Term Orientation

- People in short-term oriented culture are more concerned with truth than virtue.
- They care about present virtue and do not necessarily follow traditions.
- They are more willing to spend for the present.
- Good partnerships are not necessarily equivalent to long-term relationships.

Long-Term Orientation

- The issue of virtue is particularly important in Asia.
- People in long-term oriented culture tend to concern about future virtue and traditions.
- They are willing to save for the future.
- They value long-term partnership.

Like the Other Dimensions, Indulgence Has Two Orientations

Cultures with an orientation towards **INDULGENCE**:

- Have fewer restrictions on behavior
- Value free expression of opinions
- Are more likely to display optimism
- Tend to be more active in sports; value leisure
- Have a higher crime rate

Cultures with an orientation towards **RESTRAINT**:

- Have more restrictions on behavior
- Feel that free expression of opinions is unimportant
- Are more likely to display pessimism
- Have less participation in sports; value the work ethic
- Have a lower crime rate

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Suggestions for Managing Cultural Diversity

- Help Employees Build Cultural Intelligence
- Avoid Ethnocentrism
- Listen to Locals
- Recognize That Culture Changes
- Do Not Always Assume That Culture Is the Problem